DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL JANKIPURAM, LUCKNOW

SESSION 2025 - 2026 : PERIODIC ASSESSMENT II

SET A

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (184)

MM: 80 **Time: 3 Hrs**

Date:_____ Name_____ Class: X Sec: _____

General Instructions:

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them.

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections-
   Section A: Reading Skills
   Section-B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   Section- C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.

SECTION A

READING SKILLS

1. Read the passage. **(10)**

1. The choices we make on a daily basis-wearing a seat belt, lifting heavy objects correctly or purposely staying out of any dangerous situation-can either ensure our safety or bring about potentially harmful circumstances.

2. You and I need to make a decision that we are going to get our lives in order. Exercising self-control, self-discipline and establishing boundaries and borders in our lives are some of the most important things we can do. A life without discipline is one that's filled with carelessness.

3. We can think it's kind of exciting to live life on the edge. We like the image of "Yeah! That's me! Living on the edge! Woo-hoo!" It's become a popular way to look at life. But if you see, even highways have lines, which provide margins for our safety while we're driving. If we go over one side, we'll go into the ditch. If we cross over the line in the middle, we could get killed. And we like those lines because they help to keep us safe. Sometimes we don't even realise how lines help to keep us safe.

4. I'm not proud of this, but for the first 20 years of my life at work, I ignored my limits. I felt horrible, physically, most of the time. I used to tell myself "I know I have limits and that I've reached them, but I'm going to ignore them and see if or how long I can get by with it." I ran to doctors, trying to make myself feel better through pills, vitamins, natural stuff and anything I could get my hands on. Some of the doctors would tell me, "It's just stress." That just made me mad. I thought stress meant you don't like what you do or can't handle life, and I love what I do. But I kept pushing myself, travelling, doing speaking engagements and so on-simply exhausting myself.

5. Finally, I understood I was living an unsustainable life and needed to make some changes in my outlook and lifestyle,

6. You and I don't have to be like everyone else or keep up with anyone else. Each of us needs to be exactly the way we are, and we don't have to apologise for it. We're not all alike and we need to find a

comfort zone in which we can enjoy our lives instead of making ourselves sick with an overload of stress and pressure. (409 Words)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. **The essence of the author's article seems to be that one should believe in the motto 'Be yourself!' Justify with evidence from the text.** [Paragraph 6] (2)

II. **Complete the following with the correct option from the two given.** [Paragraph 3] (1)

The author reiterates that living life on the edge has become popular because _____.

(i) most people think that this perpetual stress and pressure are exciting.

(ii) it is an image we do not like to keep up for public.

III. **What was the writer's attitude towards the diagnosis of the doctors about him being stressed?** [Paragraph 4] (2)

IV. **What kind of life was the writer leading before the realisation dawned upon him that it was an unhealthy way of living?** [Paragraph 4] (1)

A. He was establishing boundaries for himself.

B. He was exercising a life of self- restraint.

C. He was constantly pushing and exhausting himself.

D. He was being cautious about his limits.

V. **Say whether the given statement is True or False.** [Paragraph 5] (1)

The author's outlook was more at fault than his lifestyle.

VI. **The phrase *'unsustainable practice'* is mentioned in the passage. Which of the following is an 'unsustainable practice' in the following options?** [Paragraph 5] (1)

(i) Afforestation and reforestation

(ii) Large number of tourists in the hills

(iii) Popularising degradable plastics

(iv) Using cutlery made from bamboo

VII. **Select the option that best reflects the meaning of a 'trap' in the following sentence.** [Paragraph 1]

Spiders use this silk to make webs to trap their prey. (1)

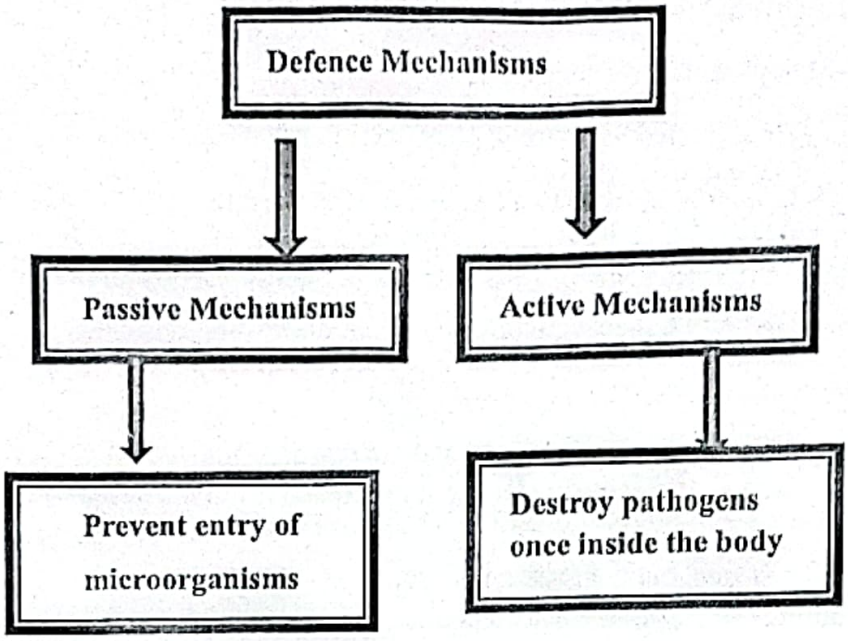
A. emancipate C. extricate
B. disengage D. confine

VIII. Choose the option that lists the quote best expressing the central idea of the passage.[Paragraph 6] (1)

A. Be unapologetic about yourself.
B. Do what we like to do in life.
C. Make the right choices.
D. Lead a disciplined life exercising self- control.

2. **Read the passage.** (10)

Summary of the defence mechanisms of the human body



The Way the Human Body Defends

1. The defence mechanism of the human body is a gift of nature. The power of our body to fight against various disease-producing agents is known as defensive mechanism. This defensive mechanism can be categorised mainly into two types-common factors and special factors.

2. Amongst the common factors, the most important is the health of human beings. If we are have good health, our body automatically remains protected against the diseases. For keeping good health one should have nutritious balanced diet. A balanced diet is that which contains carbohydrates, fat, proteins, vitamins in proportionate amount.

3. The skin of our body saves us against many microorganisms producing diseases, provided that it is intact. In case, there are cuts or abrasions on it, the microorganisms penetrate the body through those cuts and abrasions and can cause diseases. Therefore, a cut or an abrasion should never be left open.

4. The human body secretes a variety of fluids, which are killers for disease causing microorganisms. For example, gastric juice (acidic in nature) secreted by our intestinal tract kills all organisms which enter our body through food.

5. Fever is one of the most important constituents of the defensive mechanism of our body. The organ which regulates the temperature of our body is known as hypothalamus and it is situated in the brain. When microorganisms after entering the body release toxic products and these reach the brain through blood, the hypothalamus starts increasing the temperature of body and the person gets fever. This fever is very useful for the human body because by the increase of temperature, the microorganisms which are the root cause of the problem get killed.

6. We are living in an environment which is full of bacteria. Many of these bacteria can produce serious diseases, but all of us do not suffer from such diseases. It is due to a special power present in our body to fight these diseases. A part of this special power of our body is known as innate immunity. This is inherited by us. The other part of this special power is called acquired immunity. This we gain during our lifetime. (358 Words)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above,

I. Which of these facts about a fever is untrue? [Paragraph 5] (1)

A. It is regulated by hypothalamus located in the blood vessels.

B. It is part of our body's defensive mechanism,

C. Hypothalamus gets activated when toxic products reach it.

D. Fever helps to kill microorganisms that have entered the body.

II. Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. [Paragraph 6] (1)

Assertion: The human body has special powers to fight diseases.

Reason: It is only made possible by innate immunity.

A. Both the assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
B. Both the assertion and reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

III. Identify the word the writer has used to denote or imply "balanced" in paragraph 2. (1)

IV. What is the role of the skin as a defence mechanism? [Paragraph 3] (1)

V. Read the given prompt and select the correct option to fill in the blank: [Paragraph 4] (1)

Fill up a word that means "of the stomach".

The doctor explained the _____to the patient in layman's language.

A. outer abdominal issues

B. gastric problem

C. problem related to the large intestine

D. belly problem

VI. According to the author, which common factor is the most important one in protecting our body from diseases and how? [Paragraphs 1 and 2] (2)

VII. Complete the following sentence suitably: [Paragraph 1] (1)

Defensive mechanism can be defined as the power of.....

VIII. Complete the following sentence with a suitable reason: [Paragraph 4] (1)

Gastric juice secreted by our intestinal tract kills all extraneous organisms because.....

IX. What does the author say about our environment and the role of bacteria? [Paragraph 6] (1)

SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS AND GRAMMAR (20 marks)

GRAMMAR

3. Complete any ten of twelve of the following tasks, as directed. (10)

I. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the brackets, for the given portion of a letter. (1)

I am also enclosing documents ..... (mention) our terms and conditions with this letter. Please go through the same and if you have any doubts regarding that, please feel free to call or meet me personally (1)

...fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the sentence to update the result of the regional science fair:

(1)

We have exciting news to share!

Our school .....the first place in the regional science fair.

A. awarded B. was awarded C. had awarded D. has been awarded

III. Select the correct option to fill in the blank for the given line, from a health magazine. (1)

Nowadays, parents are concerned about the misuse of the internet by their kids as they ..... the facility of cell phones to continue their online classes.

A. had to be given
B. have to be given
C. are to be given
D. were to be given

IV. **Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line, from a news report:** (1)

The students preparing for their boards couldn't carry on their studies peacefully and the sleep of the elderly, the sickly and the infants had been ruined.

Option no.	Error	Correction
A.	couldn't	cannot
B.	on	with
C.	studies	study
D.	had been ruined	was ruined

V. **Complete the given narrative, by filling in the blanks with the correct option:** (1)

Yoga not only ..... the body but it also ..... in replenishing the mind and soul.

A. exercises, helps C. exercised, helped
B. will exercise; help D. has been exercising, helping

VI. **Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a letter:** (1)

Dear Sir

Subject: *Placement of an order for musical instruments*

This is to inform you that our school management..... (decide) to place an order with your company for the supply of music instruments; the list is given below:

VII. **Fill in the blank by using the correct word from the options given:** (1)

The management felt that the company ..... include corporate social responsibility as a part of its mission statement and work for the betterment of the society.

A. must B. ought C. might need

VIII. **Identify the error in the given sentence, from a company's magazine report and supply the correction.** (1)

Many meetings, including large flagship conferences, had been pushed online post pande... result of the global demand for convenience.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

IX. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to conclude the report: (1)

The report concludes that ..... learners have ..... knowledge of astrophysics.

A. very few/ some B. some/ every C. every/ no D. no/ a lot of

X. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete the given statement. (1)

A poor man ..... not even get a chance ever to come out of this vicious circle of poverty.

A. may B. can C. could D. will

XI. Complete the lines of a self- awareness song, filling in the blank with the correct option: (1)

The autumn breeze cradles your thoughts,

The falling leaves ..... your melancholy,

The sunset paints your mood,

As the evening ushers in the night.

A. share B. shares C. shared D. shall share

XII. Identify the error on a shop's hoarding and supply the correction, for the following: (1)

Visit Tresses

For latest men's and woman's hairstyles

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

WRITING

Note: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4A. You are Rahul/ Rita Sharma, a student of DIPS, Preet Vihar, Noida. You have recently noticed that the street in front of the school is being used as a thoroughfare by vehicles because of the construction work on the main street. This has led to a number of near fatal accidents involving school students who have become vulnerable to road injuries and exposure to toxic air and noise pollution while going to school. Write a letter to the Editor of a local daily in about 120 words highlighting the problem. You may also suggest possible solutions such as road safety signs, speed breakers, traffic timings, etc. 5

OR

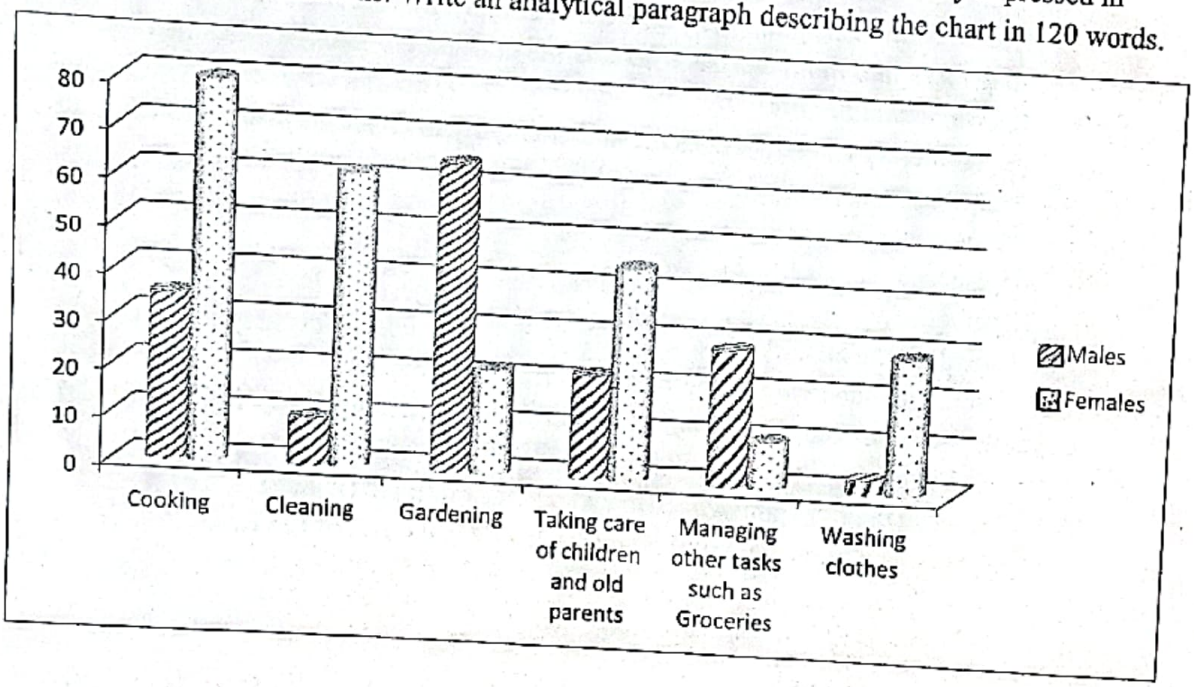
4B. Your school is going to host a grand musical extravaganza next month. As the Head of the music department of your school, write a letter to Hyderabad Music House, placing an order for some music instruments required for your school choir and band. Also give specifications of the products and their quality. You are Anil/ Anjali Sinha of DIPS School, Vijay Nagar, Hyderabad. 5

5A Teenagers have different tastes in spending their free time. The following data shows how teenagers spend their free time. Write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words analysing how boys and girls spend their free time: 5

S. No.	Hobbies	Boys (%)	Girls (%)
1.	Reading books and comics	12	25
2.	Watching movies and songs	15	35
3.	Talking to their friends	10	20
4.	Watching sports	16	4
5.	Playing outdoor and indoor games	40	20

OR

5B. The given chart shows the division of household chores by gender in a city expressed in percentage on the vertical axis. Write an analytical paragraph describing the chart in 120 words. 5



SECTION C

LITERATURE TEXTBOOK

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. **(40 marks)**

A. *The question he tried to answer was simple: What is the purpose of the twelve tiny gold spots on a monarch pupa?" Everyone assumed the spots were just ornamental," Ebright said. "But* 5

Dr Urquhart didn't believe it." To find the answer, Ebright and another excellent ... student first had to build a device that showed that the spots were producing a hormone necessary for the butterfly's full development. This project won Ebright first place in the county fair and entry into the International Science and Engineering Fair. There he won third place for zoology. He also got a chance to work during the summer at the entomology laboratory of the Walter Reed Army Institute of Research.

(The Making of a Scientist) (1)

I. State TRUE or FALSE.

None of the terms (i)-(iv) below, can be applied to the question - What is the purpose of the twelve tiny gold spots on a monarch pupa?

i. A hypothesis-a proposed explanation for a phenomenon

ii. An assumption-something that is taken for granted or assumed to be true without proof

iii. A premise-a proposition that forms the basis of an argument

iv. A theory-a well-substantiated explanation for a natural phenomenon

II. How does the author's writing style in this extract contribute to the clarity of scientific discovery? (2)

III. Ebright's project on the monarch pupa won him …….. at the county science fair. (recognition, indifference) (1)

IV. State any one inference about Dr Urquhart from the given context: *"Everyone assumed the spots were just ornamental," Ebright said. "But Dr Urquhart didn't believe it."* (1)

OR

B. *She looked at me very strangely, and then laughed. "Another aeroplane? Up there in this storm? No other aeroplanes were flying tonight. Yours was the only one I could see on the radar. So who helped me to arrive there safely without a compass or a radio, and without any more fuel in my tanks? Who was the pilot on the strange black aeroplane, flying in the storm, without lights?* *(Two Stories About Flying: Black Aeroplane)*

I. What literary technique does the author employ to create suspense in the narrative? (1)

i. Imagery

ii. Irony

iii. Hyperbole

iv. Symbolism

II. How does the author's choice of writing style enhance the mystery in the story? (2)

III. Fill in the blank with the correct word from the bracket.

The protagonist noticed that their aircraft was out of …….. (fuel/ lights/ altitude) as they approached airport. (1)

IV. What made the protagonist question who helped him land safely? (1)

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two. 5

A. *Belinda still lives in her little white house,*

With her little black kitten and her little grey mouse,

And her little yellow dog and her little red wagon,

And her realio, trulio little pet dragon.

(The Tale of Custard the Dragon)

I. How does the repetition of the word "little" contribute to the tone of the extract? (1)

II. Custard the Dragon was a .....little dragon who lived in a little white house. (brave, cowardly)

III. What does Custard the Dragon fear the most in the poem? (1)

IV. Select the option that applies the same rhyme scheme as the lines of the given extract. (2)

A. In the garden where roses bloom
The evening sky turns gold and red
A gentle breeze stirs the leaves
As twilight settles on the bed. (1)

B. The stars are bright in the midnight sky
Their light is a beacon so high
They sparkle and shimmer with a sigh
Guiding the dreams as they fly.

C. The cat sat on a mat in the sun
The dog chased after a bit of fun
The mouse scurried through the grass
While the dragon watched the moments pass.

D. The river flows with a gentle grace
Reflecting the colours of the sky
The trees stand tall in their serene place
As clouds drift slowly by

OR

B. *My head is full of whispers*
which tomorrow will be silent.
Listen. The glass is breaking.
The trees are stumbling forward
into the night. Winds rush to meet them.
(The Trees)

I. Fill the blank with one word. (1)
When the speaker says that the glass is breaking, she metaphorically refers to restraints on ..... being removed as the society became progressive.

II. What does the speaker's use of the word 'trees', metaphorically suggest? (2)

III. Which of the following best describes the speaker's attitude towards the changing tide? (1)

A. Banal C. Worried
B. Jubilant D. Discontent

IV. Comment on the poet's use of language in these lines. (1)

8. **Answer ANY FOUR of the following five questions, in about 50 words each. (4 x 3= 12)**

I. In 'Mijbil the Otter', how does Gavin Maxwell's perspective on the natural world change as a result of his interactions with Mijbil? (3)

II. Elaborate the use of allusion in Amanda! (3)

III. What does Mandela mean by the phrase 'rainbow gathering'? (Nelson Mandela: A Long Walk to Freedom) (3)

IV. Describe the conductor's demeanour towards Valli in the story Madam Rides the Bus. (3)

V. How does the imagery of the snow falling on the hemlock tree in 'Dust of Snow' reflect broader themes of transformation and the impact of nature on human emotions? (3)

9. **Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions, in about 40- 50 words each. (2x3= 6)**

I. How does 'A Triumph of Surgery' incorporate elements of humour and satire to critique the attitudes toward pets and their owner? (3)

II. Why do you think Anil didn't reveal his knowledge of Hari Singh's theft? (3)

III. Having a supportive figure in childhood encourages inquisitiveness and critical thinking early in childhood. Discuss in context of Richard Wright in 'Making of a Scientist'? (3)

10. **Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100- 120 words each. (1x6= 6)**

I. How might the themes of loss and acceptance in "The Ball Poem' by John Berryman and 'A Letter to God' by Gregorio Lopez Fuentes reflect differing societal attitudes toward personal versus communal responsibility?

OR

II. Contrast the themes of tradition and modernity in 'A Baker from Goa' and 'Coorg'. How do these two stories reflect the balance between cultural heritage and contemporary life?

11. **Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100- 120 words each. (1x6= 6)**

I. Evaluate how the character of Horace Danby is shaped by his ambition, his criminal actions and the reactions of the characters around him in 'A Question of Trust'.

OR

II. Evaluate how the characterisation of the thief, Hari, contributes significantly to the overarching theme of redemption and the complexity of human nature in "The Thief's Story'.

NOTE: The assessment scheme of the Academic Session 2024- 2025 will continue in the current session 2025- 26.